



CAMERA OPERATOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

The role of a camera operator involves recording moving images for films, TV shows, music videos, or commercials using digital video and film cameras. As a camera operator, you use both technical and creative skills to follow a script, visualize and frame shots under instructions from a director, and work closely with performers and other members of the crew during the shoot.



SALARY

Camera assistant ★★★★★
Experienced operator ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Freelance work common • Full-time employment opportunities with large broadcasting companies • A number of jobs available in corporate and training video production

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Photography and videography • Cinema, film, and video • Art • Electronics • Design technology • Media • Travel



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree is useful, but practical knowledge of videography and work experience in the industry can be enough to get you a job.



LIFESTYLE Long hours and tight deadlines are common. Operators may also have to travel to distant or extreme locations, such as deserts or war zones.



LOCATION Depending on the job, camera operators may work primarily in a studio or on location. They may need to spend extended periods away from home.



THE REALITIES Competition for jobs is intense, and many camera operators are self-employed, moving from one contract to another.

CAREER PATHS

Many camera operators get their foothold in the industry by working as production assistants ("runners"). Your progress will depend on your talent and commitment, as well as on the way in which you develop a network of contacts in the industry.

ASSISTANT With some technical knowledge of film-making, you may become a camera assistant. Your job is to assemble the cameras, and keep shots in focus. With experience you can become a camera operator.



GRADUATE You can study for a degree in photography, film and TV production, cinematography, or media studies, but technical ability and experience count for more than academic study.

